

EXAM 7 SPRING 2016 SAMPLE ANSWERS AND EXAMINER'S REPORT

GENERAL COMMENTS:

- Candidates should note that the instructions to the exam explicitly say to show all work; graders expect to see enough support on the candidate's answer sheet to follow the calculations performed. While the graders made every attempt to follow calculations that were not well-documented, lack of documentation often resulted in the deduction of points where the calculations could not be followed or were not sufficiently supported.
- Candidates should justify all selections when prompted to do so. For example, if the candidate selects an all-year average and the question prompts a justification of all selections, a brief explanation should be provided for the reasoning behind this selection. Candidates should note that a restatement of a numerical selection in words is not a justification.
- Incorrect responses in one item part did not preclude candidates from receiving credit for correct work on subsequent item parts that depended upon that response.
- Candidates should pay attention to the wording of each exam item. They must look for key words such as "briefly" or "fully". We refer candidates to the December 2009 *Future Fellows* article "The Importance of Adverbs" for additional information on this topic. For example, some candidates provided lengthy responses to a "briefly describe" question, which does not earn further credit, but instead merely takes up valuable exam time.
- Candidates should be cautious of relying solely on study manuals; many candidates lost credit for failing to provide basic insights and content contained in the syllabus readings.
- Candidates should note that the sample answers provided in the examiner's report are not an exhaustive representation of all responses given credit during grading, but rather the most common correct responses.
- In cases where a given number of items were requested (e.g., "three reasons" or "two scenarios"), the examiner's report often provides more sample answers than the requested number. The additional responses are provided for educational value, and would not have resulted in any additional credit for candidates who provided more than the requested number of responses. Candidates are reminded that, per the instructions to the exam, when a specific number of items is requested, only the items adding up to that number will be graded (i.e., if two items are requested and three are provided, only the first two are graded).

EXAM STATISTICS:

- Number of Candidates: 603
- Available Points: 61.50
- Passing Score: 45.25
- Number of Passing Candidates: 226
- Raw Pass Ratio: 37.5%
- Effective Pass Ratio: 39.0%